全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 16 單元 | 犯罪與衝突 · Crime & Conflict

The Mystery of the Missing Class Fund

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"Someone has stolen the class fund," Amy announced on Monday morning, holding up an empty envelope. Two thousand dollars, collected for the graduation trip, had disappeared from her desk over the weekend. The classroom fell silent. Then Jason, who sat behind her, pointed at Ken. "He stayed late on Friday. He's the suspect." Ken turned red. "Are you accusing me? I was cleaning the board! I'm innocent!" Within seconds, the two boys were in the middle of a loud quarrel.

Mr. Huang, our homeroom teacher, walked in before the argument turned into something worse. "Nobody is guilty until we have proof," he said calmly, sounding like a detective in a TV drama. "A theft is a serious offense, and so is a false accusation. Who was the last person to see the envelope?" A quiet girl named Lily raised her hand. "I'm a witness," she said. "On Friday afternoon, I saw Amy put the envelope in her bag, not her desk."

Amy's face changed. She opened her bag, dug through a pile of textbooks, and pulled out the envelope, slightly bent but full. "I must have forgotten," she whispered. The classroom exploded with laughter, but Mr. Huang did not smile. "Jason, you confronted a classmate with no evidence and threatened his reputation. The penalty is a written apology." Jason nodded, and so did Ken, who had been ready to defend himself all morning.

That afternoon, the two boys walked home together as if nothing had happened. Still, I learned something I will not forget. In real life, there is rarely a criminal hiding in the shadows. More often, the "crime" is just a mistake, and the real victim is the person we are too quick to accuse.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
suspect	*n.*	嫌疑犯	The police questioned two suspects about the robbery. 警方就搶案偵訊了兩名嫌疑犯。

accuse	*v.*	指控；控告	She accused her brother of breaking her phone. 她指控弟弟弄壞了她的手機。
innocent	*adj.*	無辜的；無罪的	The man insisted that he was innocent. 這名男子堅稱自己是無辜的。
quarrel	*n.*	爭吵	The two sisters had a quarrel over the remote control. 兩姊妹為了遙控器吵了一架。
guilty	*adj.*	有罪的；內疚的	The court found him guilty of stealing. 法院判定他犯了竊盜罪。
theft	*n.*	偷竊	Bicycle theft is common near the train station. 火車站附近腳踏車失竊很常見。
offense	*n.*	罪行；違法行為	Driving without a license is a serious offense. 無照駕駛是嚴重的違法行為。
witness	*n.*	目擊者；證人	A witness told the police what she had seen. 一位目擊者告訴警方她所看到的事。
confront	*v.*	當面對質；面對	He finally confronted his friend about the lie. 他終於就那個謊言和朋友當面對質。
penalty	*n.*	處罰；罰款	The penalty for parking here is 900 dollars. 在這裡停車的罰款是九百元。

片語 Phrases

fall silent	陷入沉默	The crowd fell silent when the singer walked on stage. 歌手走上舞台時，群眾安靜了下來。
turn into	變成	The small argument turned into a big fight. 小爭執變成了大吵架。
as if nothing had happened	彷彿什麼事都沒發生	She smiled and kept talking as if nothing had happened. 她微笑著繼續說話，彷彿什麼事都沒發生過。

文法與句型 Grammar

Nobody / No one + V + until + S + V

「直到…之前，沒有人…」，until 引導時間子句，說明某狀態持續到某個時間點才改變。文章第二段：Nobody is guilty until we have proof.

Nobody may leave the room until the test is over.

考試結束前，任何人都不得離開教室。

S + must have + p.p.

「一定是…了」，用來表示對過去事情的肯定推測。文章第三段：I must have forgotten.

The ground is wet. It must have rained last night.

地面是濕的，昨晚一定下過雨。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。